

BBA Chapter 3 — Aramaic Syllabification Drill

Open/Closed Syllables · Dagesh Forte · Guttural Quiescence · Accent

For each word: (1) divide into syllables using |, (2) label each syllable O (open) or C (closed), (3) mark stressed syllable with ' , (4) note any special features (Dagesh Forte, quiescence, etc.).

Part A — Basic Division (1–8)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
1	מַלְכָּא	malkā'				
2	אֵלְהָא	'ēlāhā'				
3	בֵּית	bêt				
4	מַלְכִין	malkîn				
5	כְּתָב	ketab				
6	אֲבוּהִי	'ābūhî				
7	יְהוּד	yəhûd				
8	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā'				

Part A — Basic Division (1–8) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
1	מַלְכָּא	malkā'				
✓	מַלְכָּא	malkā'	א.כ. ל.מ	C · C	א.כ'	Final ʾ quiescent (det. state)
2	אֵלְהָא	'ēlāhā'				
✓	אֵלְהָא	'ēlāhā'	א.ה. ל.א	O · O · C	א.ה'	Hateph seghol; final ʾ quiescent
3	בֵּית	bêt				
✓	בֵּית	bêt	ת.י.ב	C	ת.י.ב'	Waw is mater for Tsere
4	מַלְכִּין	malkîn				
✓	מַלְכִּין	malkîn	י.כ. ל.מ	C · C	י.כ'	Yod is mater for Hireq Gadol
5	כְּתָב	ketab				
✓	כְּתָב	ketab	ב.ת. כ.א	O · C	ב.ת'	Opening sheva = vocal
6	אֲבוּהִי	'ābûhî				
✓	אֲבוּהִי	'ābûhî	י.ה. ו.ב. א.א	O · O · O	י.ה'	Hateph Patach; Waw = Shuruq; Yod =
7	יְהוּד	yəhûd				
✓	יְהוּד	yəhûd	י.ד.וה י.א	O · C	י.ד.וה'	Opening sheva = vocal; Waw = Shuruq
8	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā'				
✓	שְׁמַיָּא	šəmayyā'	א.י. י.מ. ש.ש	O · C · C	א.י'	Dagesh Forte in Yod = doubled

Part B — Dagesh Forte Doubling (9–12)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
9	שַׁבָּת	šabbat				
10	כַּסְסָּדִים	kaššədîm				
11	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn				
12	מִנְיָ	minnay				

Part B — Dagesh Forte Doubling (9–12) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
9	שַׁבָּת	šabbat				
✓	שַׁבָּת	šabbat	תִּבְּ בִּשְׁ	C · C	תִּבְּ	Dagesh Forte in Beth
10	כְּסָדִים	kaśśədīm				
✓	כְּסָדִים	kaśśədīm	מִידְּ סִכְ	C · C	מִידְּ	Dagesh Forte in Samech
11	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn				
✓	הַדְּבָרִין	haddabrîn	וִירְ בְּדִ דְּה	C · C · C	וִירְ	Dagesh Forte in Dalet
12	מִנִּי	minnay				
✓	מִנִּי	minnay	יִנְ נִמְ	C · O	יִנְ	Dagesh Forte in Nun (assimilation)

Part C — Guttural and Quiescence Features (13–16)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
13	אָמַר	ʾāmar				
14	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm				
15	עַם	ʿim				
16	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak				

Part C — Guttural and Quiescence Features (13–16) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
13	אָמַר	ʾāmar				
✓	אָמַר	ʾāmar	רִמְ אֶ	O · C	רִמְ	Long Qamets in open syllable; Aleph
14	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm				
✓	חֲכִים	ḥakkīm	מִיכְ כִּחְ	C · C	מִיכְ	Dagesh Forte in Kaph; Cheth = guttural
15	עַם	ʿim				
✓	עַם	ʿim	מֶע	C	מֶע	Ayin = guttural; short Hireq in closed
16	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak				
✓	מִלְאָךְ	malʾak	רֶא לִמְ	C · C	רֶא	Aleph in second syllable; takes Patach

Part D — Accent and Vowel Reduction (17–20)

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
17	נְבוֹכַדְנֶשְׁשָׁר	nəbûḱadneššar				
18	מַלְכֻתָּא	malkûtā'				
19	בְּיֹם	bəyôm				
20	לְמַלְכָּא	ləmalkā'				

Part D — Accent and Vowel Reduction (17–20) — Answer Key

#	Word	Translit.	Division	Types	Stress	Special Features
17	נְבוֹכַדְנֶשְׁשָׁר	nəbûḱadneššar				
✓	נְבוֹכַדְנֶשְׁשָׁר	nəbûḱadneššar	רֶצֶץ־נִידְכִּי־וּבִי־נ	O·O·C·C·C	רֶצֶץ	Opening vocal sheva; Dagesh Forte in
18	מַלְכֻתָּא	malkûtā'				
✓	מַלְכֻתָּא	malkûtā'	אֶת־וּכְלִמַּ	C·O·C	אֶת	Waw = Shuruq; final ʾ quiescent
19	בְּיֹם	bəyôm				
✓	בְּיֹם	bəyôm	מִי־וֹיֵב	O·C	מִי	Prefix בְּ = vocal sheva; Waw = Holem
20	לְמַלְכָּא	ləmalkā'				
✓	לְמַלְכָּא	ləmalkā'	אֶכְלִמַּל־	O·C·C	אֶכְ	Prefix לְ = vocal sheva; propretonic מֶ